

inclinations. Balodimas's comment that "I always take some money off the table when the market is in my favor" resonated in my mind to beneficial effect, as some of my trades that went nowhere ended up generating net profits.

Over the years, many people have told me that reading the original *Market Wizards* books changed their careers and changed their lives. I have been told this both by professional managers and by numerous attendees at my conference talks. I never know whether this life-changing impact is for the better. One time, a physician told me that he dropped his career to become a trader after reading my book, and I actually felt guilty about having deprived the world of a doctor in exchange for one more trader. Ironically, one of the people whose lives was changed by the *Market Wizards* books was my own son, Zachary, who also had a direct impact on the content of this book. Here, too, I don't know whether the change will be for the better or worse, and will never know because the proverbial road not taken remains forever unseen. I thought it was appropriate to end with his personal reflections on the message and influence of this book and its predecessors as offering a view from the perspective of someone discovering and entering the world of trading.

Jack Schwager



The *Market Wizard* series has come to shape a great deal of my life, more than I could have ever anticipated.

I was 8 years old. It was "bring your child to work" day. I loved my dad's office. It was full of things that I was not supposed to touch. Better yet, he had a secretary with a large bowl of candy and apparently no inhibitions about increasing my chances for an early onset of diabetes. I was off in the corner disassembling my father's coffee machine when he called me over for a game. The rules of the game were simple. He would cycle through charts; it was my job to guess whether the chart's next move was going to be up or down. It wouldn't be until much later in my life that I would find out that this wasn't a game at all. It was an experiment. My father has, and still holds, a theory that some individuals are naturally gifted traders who